Real-Life Role Equivalents and Press Personas

Volume 10 — locked in. In the real-world story, some fictional actors **take over the off-screen roles** real MCU actors played: how they were cast, what part they played in the franchise, and how they behaved on press tours.

1. Marc-Anthony = Robert Downey Jr.

Marc-Anthony fills **Robert Downey Jr.'s place** in MCU history as Tony Stark / Iron Man: the actor who launches the universe and becomes its face, anchor and leader.

- **The casting fight (2006):** as with Downey, Jon Favreau champions him and the studio resists. Marvel's doubt isn't addiction or insurability. It's the child-star image (Volume 07) and how it would look to cast a Donohue grandson. Favreau insists on a screen test, and the test settles it. In real life Downey's casting was announced **September 29, 2006**; Marc's announcement falls in the same window.
- **The creative engine:** he improvises like Downey did, rewriting lines on the day and finding the jokes in rehearsal. The defining unscripted moment at the end of *Iron Man* (2008), *"I am Iron Man,"* is his.
- **The franchise anchor:** his performance defines the MCU's tone. He headlines the Iron Man films and is the center of every *Avengers* ensemble, the first-billed star and the leader of the cast off screen.
- **The narrative:** where Downey's was *the comeback*, Marc's is *the boy who became a man*: Hollywood finally sees him as more than J.T. Tate and Danny Price, and he still never disowns them.
- What happens to Tony Stark on screen in each film follows our comic-accuracy rules (Volume 01). Marc's real-world role is fixed and the in-universe story beats are decided film by film.

2. Amond Baker = Mark Ruffalo (Spoilers)

Amond fills **Mark Ruffalo's role as the MCU's famous spoiler machine**. He plays Bruce Banner from *The Incredible Hulk* (2008) onward, and he cannot keep a secret to save his life.

- **His spoiler history mirrors Ruffalo's real one**, at the equivalent moments: accidentally livestreaming a premiere's audio from his pocket, letting a finale's ending slip on a talk show, and hinting at plot twists he wasn't supposed to know.
- **Fake scripts:** Marvel starts giving him only his own pages, or scripts with fake scenes. He's proud of it. *"They gave me a script where the Hulk opens a bakery. I believed it for a week."*
- **The studio's nightmare:** Marvel's publicity team assigns a handler just to him. Kevin Feige jokes in interviews that Amond has his own security clearance level, which is "none."
- **The public loves him for it.** Each leak becomes a viral moment, and the leaked secrets never actually ruin anything.

3. Marc-Anthony's Fake-Movie Prank

On every press tour, Marc pranks interviewers by **inventing a completely fake movie with a straight face**, with all his cast mates in it. He describes plots, scenes and behind-the-scenes stories in such detail that reporters write them down. Cast mates have to play along live, and some are far better at it than others.

Press tour	The fake movie (examples)
Iron Man (2008)	***Iron Man: The Musical***. Marc insists the film is secretly a Broadway-style musical: Tayia Boyd has a torch song about filing paperwork, Terrence Howard does a tap number in the War Machine armor, and Jeff Bridges “sings bass on the villain song.” MTV runs it as news for a day.
Iron Man 2 (2010)	***Rhodey & Tony's Excellent Road Trip***, a buddy road movie co-starring Don Cheadle, with Harmony Divine as a hitchhiker and Elxa Bullock as a diner waitress who “steals the whole movie.”
The Avengers (2012)	***Avengers: Brunch***, a three-hour movie where the team argues about brunch. Esther Smilley's Thor orders “all of the pancakes,” Tyrese Avery's Captain America sings the menu, and David Tipton plays a waiter. Amond tries to play along and accidentally describes a real scene.
Later tours	A new fake movie every time: courtroom dramas, cooking shows, family holiday dinners. Fans start campaigns demanding the fake films get made, and Marvel's social media team eventually joins in.

The perfect double act: Marc's pranks plus Amond's spoilers make every junket unpredictable. Marc invents a fake plot, Amond tries to go along with it, and Amond leaks something real by accident. Reporters can't tell which parts are true, and that becomes the best spoiler protection Marvel ever had.